site for construction. Each and every individual spend a major portion of their savings for purchasing a site and constructing a house. After which they don't move away or change their house. Therefore a good sense regarding site selection and house construction becomes necessary.

1.4.1 Factors to be considered during site selection.

1. **Physical features**
   - i. The plot should be regular with well-defined boundaries on all sides.
   - ii. It is better to have an elevated plot when compared to its surrounding areas for better visualisation.
   - iii. In elevated areas, water does not stagnate which becomes ideal for living.
   - iv. If the site is in low-lying area, it leads to water stagnation, breeding of insects and unhealthy living condition.
   - v. It is always better to choose a site oriented towards North or South for better air flow.
2. **Soil conditions**

   Before constructing the house, it is always advisable to check the properties of the soil. This will avoid unnecessary problems during construction and prevent loss of money.
   - i. Clayey soil is not good for construction. Because it does not absorb water and retains it.
   - ii. Sandy soil absorbs water quickly and hence a strong foundation cannot be laid on it. More over sandy soil is not suited for gardening.
   - iii. Strong foundation could be laid on a rocky strata but it is not an ideal site for house construction as it radiate heat during night.
   - iv. Hence a site consisting of soft soil at top and hard soil at the bottom at a depth of 0.9 to 1.2 m is considered ideal for house construction.
3. **Sanitary facilities**
   - i. The area surrounding the proposed plot of house construction should be free from stagnated water, small ponds and deteriorated wells.
   - ii. Care should be taken to see that there are no open drainage or public toilets near the plot.
   - iii. For the benefit of the family members, the plot should not be selected near cow sheds, poultry farms, industries and burial/ cremation grounds.
   - iv. Low lying areas which were later filled up with garbage, other city wastes and disposed materials should never be selected for house construction. Because, the bearing capacity of such areas will not be firm or strong. Moreover at the time of heavy rain, these dumped up areas become saturated and promote the breeding of mosquitoes and flies, polluting the surrounding atmosphere with foul smell and causing threat to health.
   - v. It is advisable to select a plot with fresh air, adequate light, good water supply and modern sanitary facilities.
4. **Practical conveniences**
   - i. A plot is valued based on the basic facilities that are available around it.
   - ii. A plot should be located in such a way that schools, bank, hospital,

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